

Atlas Formats (General Guide)

Format	Length	Purpose
Flagship Report	30–50 pages	Major original investigations that combine research, analysis, and recommendations.
Case Study	15–25 pages	Deep dives into a single organization, institution, or event ending with recommendations or lessons.
White Paper	15–25 pages	Research synthesis and original frameworks around one central question.
Executive Memo	5–10 pages	Consultant-style recommendations written for decision makers.
Essay	1,500–4,000 words	Original arguments and reflections written for a broad audience.
Field Guide	15–30 pages or 15–30 slides	Practical guides, audits, visual systems, brand analyses, redesigns, and frameworks.
Interactive	Variable	A web-native investigation designed to be explored rather than read. Instead of scrolling through a document, visitors click, compare, filter, zoom, reveal, and navigate systems visually. Best suited for maps, timelines, ecosystems,

		comparative studies, organizational structures, and information architecture.
Atlas Note	500–1,200 words	Short observations, field notes, travel reflections, and intellectual sketches.
Reading Entry	1–4 pages	Personal synthesis of books, papers, reports, and articles.

Atlas Editorial Roadmap (Master Version)

The below is the master content roadmap for the Atlas. Ideas open to change.

I assigned each piece the format I think best fits it. If a topic felt like it would make a better essay than a 40-page report, I changed it.

STRATEGY

"How organizations compete, grow, and adapt."

Subtopic	Project	Format	Length
Market Strategy	The Michelin Guide: How a Tire Company Became One of the World's Most Trusted Cultural Institutions	Flagship Report	40–50 pp
	The Smithsonian's Next Generation: A Growth Strategy for America's Museums	Flagship Report	30–40 pp

	UNIQLO Outside Japan: What Should Global Brands Standardize—and What Should They Localize?	White Paper	15–20 pp
	Novo Nordisk: Managing Success When Demand Exceeds Supply	Case Study	20–25 pp
	Decathlon in America	Case Study	20–25 pp
	Monocle: Can a Magazine Become a Lifestyle Ecosystem?	Essay	2,000–2,500 words
Comparative Strategy	The PWHL: Building a League That Lasts	Flagship Report	25–35 pp
	Public Broadcasters: BBC vs. CBC vs. ABC Australia	White Paper	20 pp
	Global Grocery Chains: Aldi, Carrefour, Aeon & Woolworths	White Paper	20 pp
	High-Speed Rail Around the World	Flagship Report + Interactive	30–40 pp + Interactive
	International Airports: Changi, Schiphol, Incheon & Dulles	Essay	2,500–3,000 words
	Wikipedia: Competing Without Competitors	Essay	2,500 words
Strategic Partnerships	Formula One × LVMH	Case Study	20 pp
	Olympic TOP Sponsors	White Paper	20 pp
	Cities & Megaevents	White Paper	20 pp

	Spotify × FC Barcelona	Executive Memo	8–10 pp
	LEGO × NASA	Essay	2,000 words
Organizational Strategy	OpenAI: Mission vs. Commercialization	Flagship Report	35–40 pp
	The Financial Times: Reinvention as Strategy	Case Study	20 pp
	The National Trust (UK): Managing Heritage as an Organization	Essay	2,000 words
Scenario Planning	Four Futures for Higher Education	White Paper	20–25 pp
	The Future of Public Media	White Paper	20–25 pp
	Professional Services in an AI Economy	White Paper	20 pp

COMMUNICATION

"How organizations reduce uncertainty and build understanding."

Subtopic	Project	Format	Length
Crisis Communication	American Airlines Flight 5342	Case Study	20–25 pp
	CrowdStrike Global Outage	Case Study	20–25 pp
	Francis Scott Key Bridge	Case Study	20 pp
	Toyota Recalls	Case Study	20 pp
Organizational Communication	Every Organization Is Really a Communication System	Flagship Report	30–40 pp

	Communication Debt	White Paper	20 pp
	Why Meetings Are a Design Problem	Essay	2,500 words
	The Organization Before the Meeting	Essay	2,500 words
Institutional Communication	The Psychology of Corporate Euphemism	White Paper	20 pp
	Why the National Park Service Sounds Human	Essay	2,000 words
	The Economist's Voice	Case Study	20 pp
	A Letter to a CEO	Essay	2,000 words
Public Affairs	TikTok at Congress	White Paper	20 pp
	CDC: Communicating Uncertainty	White Paper	20 pp
	NOAA: Communicating Probability	Essay	2,500 words
	European Commission Communications	Essay	2,500 words
	Bank of Japan Communications	Essay	2,500 words
Professional Writing	Press Release (3 audiences)	Executive Memo	4–6 pp
	Annotated Executive Speech	Executive Memo	5–6 pp
	Donor Journey Email Series	Executive Memo	8 pp

	Internal Communications Brief	Executive Memo	6 pp
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INFORMATION & DESIGN

"How information shapes perception, movement, and decision-making."

Subtopic	Project	Format	Length
Identity Systems	National Geographic Brand Audit	Field Guide	25–30 pp
	Smithsonian Visual System	Field Guide	20–25 pp
	Michelin Guide Identity System	Field Guide	20 pp
	London Underground Identity	Field Guide	20 pp
Presentation	Consulting Recommendation Deck	Field Guide	20 slides
	Agency Brand Pitch	Field Guide	20 slides
	Campaign Strategy Deck	Field Guide	20 slides
	Executive Briefing Deck	Field Guide	15 slides
Information Design	Brookings Report Redesign	Field Guide	20 slides
	WHO Publication Redesign	Field Guide	20 slides
	U.S. Census Redesign	Field Guide	15 slides
	Google Hybrid Executive Report	Field Guide	15 slides
Systems Design	Airport Ecosystem	Field Guide + Interactive	20 pp + Interactive
	Changi Airport Experience	Essay + Interactive	2,000 words + Interactive

	Hong Kong MTR Wayfinding	Field Guide + Interactive	20 pp + Interactive
	Dutch Cycling Infrastructure	Field Guide + Interactive	20 pp + Interactive
	Public Transit as Information Design	Essay + Interactive	2,500 words + Interactive
Editorial Design	The Atlas Design System	Field Guide	30–40 pp
	Trend Report	Field Guide	20 slides

I/O PSYCHOLOGY

"How organizations shape human behavior."

Subtopic	Project	Format	Length
Organizations	Google's Hybrid Work Crisis	Flagship Report	35–40 pp
	Why Corporate Transformations Fail	White Paper	20–25 pp
	The Informal Organization	White Paper	20 pp
	Pixar's Braintrust	Case Study	20 pp
Leadership	Executive Derailment	White Paper	20 pp
	The All Blacks	Essay	2,500 words
	Hierarchy, Autonomy & Motivation	White Paper	20 pp
	Workplace Belonging in the Gig Economy	Case Study	20 pp

Decision Making	Decision Architecture Inside Organizations	White Paper	20 pp
	Organizational Identity Under Technological Disruption	White Paper	20–25 pp
	Trust Is an Organizational Asset	Essay	3,000 words
	Do DEI Words Change Behavior or Just Perception?	White Paper	20–25 pp
Culture & Behavior	Japanese Convenience Stores	Essay	2,000 words
	The Psychology of Queueing Across Cultures	White Paper	20 pp
	How Different Countries Design Public Space	Essay	2,500 words
	Business Culture Across East Asia	White Paper + Interactive	20 pp + Interactive
	Professional Norms Around the World	Flagship Report + Interactive	30-40 pp + Interactive

Reading

Living archive of books, articles, reports, and research papers. Entries are 1-4 ppl

Text Title:	Link (if applicable)
Outliers: The Story of Success by Malcolm Gladwell	

Thinking, Fast and Slow by Daniel Kahneman	
The Undercover Economist by Tim Harford	
Freakonomics, by Steven D. Levitt and Stephen J. Dubner	
The Psychology of Money: Timeless Lessons on Wealth, Greed, and Happiness by Morgan Housel	
Antifragile: Things That Gain From Disorder by Nassim Nicholas Taleb	
Globally-Minded Marketing: A Cultural Approach to Building Iconic Brands By Carlos J. Torelli, Maria A. Rodas	(textbook) DOI:10.1007/978-3-031-50812-7 ISBN: 978-3-031-50811-0
Propaganda by Edward Bernays	
The Inefficient Pricing of News by Antoine Didisheim, Bryan T. Kelly, Mohammad Pourmohammadi & Hanqing Tian	(Study) SSRN: 6540399

Notes

Growing short observations from travel, work, photography, and everyday life. Entries are 500–1,200 words.

Observations from the Shenzhen Metro
A Day in New York

Three Hours in Union Station
Every City Has a Different Relationship with Time
Walking Is an Underrated Research Method
Coffee Shops as Behavioral Design
Libraries Understand Attention Better Than Most Apps
Waiting Rooms Reveal More Than Waiting
Three Things I Learned About Organizations from Editing a Yearbook
Why Donor Engagement and Customer Loyalty Are the Same Behavioral Problem
How Shenzhen Changed My Understanding of Innovation
The Quiet Confidence of Public Libraries

Photography

Gallery	Collections
Editorial	Golden Hour • Solaris Graduation • Studio Portraits • Fashion Features
Events	WAMU Donor Night • Christine & Justice's Wedding • Campus Events • Conferences
Sports	Basketball • Ice Hockey • Soccer • Swimming • Volleyball
Experience	Shenzhen 2026 • A Day in New York • Nature & Stills • Washington, DC • Hong Kong (future)

Essay	Length
What Sports Photography Taught Me About Decision-Making Under Pressure	1,000-2,500 words
The Difference Between Looking and Seeing	1,000-2,500 words
Photographing Protests Changed How I Think About Attention	1,000-2,500 words

Looking at everything together, one pattern stands out. Your portfolio is no longer centered on *marketing, consulting, or even psychology* individually. Instead, it's centered on a single intellectual territory: **how institutions earn, organize, communicate, and sustain trust.**

That's a much stronger identity than "marketing student" or "future consultant." It gives every project—from a 40-page strategy report to a 700-word field note—a common thread. If you keep asking variations of that question over the next several years, the Atlas will feel less like a portfolio assembled for recruiting and more like the published work of someone developing a distinctive point of view. That's the kind of coherence that makes people remember you.

EXPLORABLE SYSTEMS

Every interactive should answer one central question:

"What becomes obvious when you can explore the system instead of reading about it?"

The written portion provides the argument. The interactive lets the reader discover the argument for themselves.

1. High-Speed Rail Around the World

Format: Flagship Report + Interactive

Question

Why have some countries built world-class high-speed rail systems while others continue to struggle?

Written Portion (30–40 pages)

The report would resemble a Brookings or OECD publication.

Topics include:

- History of high-speed rail
- Economic justification
- Political barriers
- National planning philosophies
- Governance models
- Funding structures
- Ridership
- Public trust
- Urban development
- Environmental outcomes
- Lessons for future investment

Countries compared:

- Japan
- China
- France
- Spain
- South Korea
- Germany
- Italy
- United Kingdom
- United States

Ends with

"What should the next generation of rail investment look like?"

Interactive Portion

A fully explorable world map.

Users click countries.

Each opens:

Infrastructure

- Network map
- Total kilometers
- Speed

Economics

- Construction cost
- Ridership
- Cost recovery

Operations

- Frequency
- Reliability
- Ownership

Culture

- Why people ride
- Public attitudes
- Government priorities

Users can compare two countries side-by-side.

A timeline slider shows network expansion over decades.

Hovering routes reveals

"When built"

"Ridership"

"Travel time saved"

2. Airport Ecosystem

Format: Field Guide + Interactive

Question

How does an airport function as one interconnected organizational system?

Written Portion

A systems guide.

Topics include:

- Stakeholders
- Passenger journey
- Security
- Airlines
- Government
- Retail
- Operations
- Baggage
- Wayfinding
- Information systems
- Human behavior
- Organizational coordination

Ends with recommendations for designing airports that reduce stress.

Interactive Portion

The airport becomes one large systems diagram.

Users zoom.

Click

Security.

Everything connected highlights.

Click

Baggage.

The baggage ecosystem expands.

Hovering reveals

Organizations

Responsibilities

Pain points

Decision bottlenecks

Information flows

It becomes a living systems map.

3. Changi Airport Experience

Format: Essay + Interactive

Question

Why does Changi feel fundamentally different from most airports?

Written Portion

A narrative essay.

Topics

- Hospitality philosophy
- Architecture
- Behavioral design
- Public space
- Wayfinding
- Retail
- Nature
- Waiting
- Stress reduction

Not

"Top 10 reasons."

Instead

"What philosophy of travel does Changi embody?"

Interactive Portion

Readers explore Changi.

Large floor map.

Click

Butterfly Garden

↓

Design reasoning.

Click

Immigration



Queue design.

Click

Jewel



Behavioral psychology.

Click

Transit



Movement strategy.

Every space explains

Why it exists.

4. Hong Kong MTR Wayfinding

Format: Field Guide + Interactive

Question

Why is one of the world's busiest transit systems so easy to understand?

Written Portion

Topics

Information hierarchy

Typography

Maps

Color

Accessibility

Payment

Transfer design

Behavior under time pressure

Comparison with

NYC

London

Paris

DC

Interactive Portion

A station map.

Users navigate.

Turn

Accessibility

ON

Shows routes.

Turn

Tourist

ON

Different overlays.

Turn

Rush Hour

ON

Movement changes.

Hovering signs explains

Why each sign exists.

Could even include

Animated passenger movement.

5. Dutch Cycling Infrastructure

Format: Field Guide + Interactive

Question

How do cities design cycling as transportation instead of recreation?

Written Portion

Topics

History

Policy

Street hierarchy

Protected lanes

Intersections

Parking

Behavior

Public health

Urban economics

Comparison with North America.

Interactive Portion

Street cross-sections.

Move slider.

Washington DC



Amsterdam.

Infrastructure changes live.

Click

Intersection.

Animation.

Cyclist.

Pedestrian.

Car.

Everything moves simultaneously.

Hover

Explains

Design choice.

6. Public Transit as Information Design

Format: Essay + Interactive

Question

Good transit isn't just transportation.

It's information.

Written Portion

A design essay.

Topics

Maps

Typography

Consistency

Symbols

Memory

Language

Cognitive load

Navigation

Trust

Examples

Tokyo

London

Hong Kong

New York

Interactive Portion

Users compare transit maps.

Click

Tokyo

↓

Zoom.

Click

NYC.

↓

Overlay differences.

Turn

Tourist Mode

ON.

See information overload.

Turn

Local Mode

ON.

Changes priorities.

Interactive also compares

Ticket machines

Icons

Announcements

Digital signage

7. Business Culture Across East Asia

Format: White Paper + Interactive

Question

How do organizations in East Asia make decisions differently?

Written Portion

Countries

Japan

South Korea

China

Hong Kong

Singapore

Taiwan

Topics

Hierarchy

Consensus

Speed

Negotiation

Trust

Meetings

Leadership

Conflict

Professional expectations

Generational shifts

AI

Globalization

Not stereotypes.

Evidence-based.

Interactive Portion

Choose country.

Then choose topic.

Example

Japan



Meetings



Typical structure.



Decision process.



Etiquette.



Business implications.

Switch to

China.

Everything updates.

Comparisons available.

8. Professional Norms Around the World

Format: Flagship Report + Interactive

Question

What does "professionalism" actually mean in different cultures?

Written Portion

Topics

Communication

Dress

Networking

Hierarchy

Feedback

Email

Presentations

Negotiation

Interviewing

Meetings

Conflict

Career progression

Hybrid work

Global teams

Regional case studies

Interactive Portion

This becomes the Atlas's most ambitious interactive.

A globe.

Choose

Country.



Choose

Situation.

Examples

Interview

Meeting

Networking Event

Business Dinner

Presentation

Email

Negotiation

Giving Feedback

Receiving Feedback

Everything changes.

Example

Networking.

Japan.



Exchanging business cards.



Conversation norms.



Follow-up.



Power distance.



Common mistakes.

Switch to

Germany.

Entire experience changes.

The reader isn't reading a cultural guide.

They're exploring one.

A shared design language for every Interactive

To make the Atlas feel cohesive, every interactive should follow the same structure and interaction model:

1. **Guiding Question** — A single, provocative question introduces the investigation and frames what the visitor is about to explore.
2. **Orientation** — A brief overview explains the system, why it matters, and how to navigate the interactive.
3. **Explore** — The core experience. Visitors click, compare, filter, zoom, toggle layers, reveal relationships, and move through the system at their own pace.
4. **Key Insights** — Rather than forcing conclusions throughout, the interactive periodically surfaces concise observations that connect patterns back to the broader argument.
5. **Continue Reading** — A prompt invites readers to return to the written report, essay, or field guide for deeper analysis.

This consistency means visitors quickly learn how to use every interactive. More importantly, it reinforces the identity of the Atlas: not as a collection of flashy visualizations, but as a research publication where complex systems become understandable through exploration. The interactives aren't separate from the writing—they're another way of thinking.